5.2 Preparation of Biscuits and Cookies

Aim: To obtain the skill of baking biscuits to start a bakery unit.

Equipment needed: Baking oven, mixing bowls, ladles, rolling pin and board, biscuit cutters.

Procedure

Biscuits: A small baked unleavened biscuit, typically crisp, flat and sweet.

Biscuits are classified according to the method of making like rubbed-in, creamed and so on.

Rubbed – in Biscuits: It is prepared by rubbing – in of the fat into the flour. This is done by placing the flour in a large mixing bowl, and then adding butter which has been cut into pieces then rubbing both the ingredients together between fingertips until the mixture resembles breadcrumbs.

Creamed Biscuits: Fat and sugar should be creamed like it is done for cakes. This is done by placing softened butter in a large mixing bowl, then adding the sugar, and beating the ingredients together with a wooden spoon or electric whisk, until the mixture is well blended, light and fluffy.

Depending on the type of biscuit being made, wet ingredients such as eggs or milk are stirred in before the flour or other dry ingredients are added. These dough are often very soft, so small spoonful are dropped onto baking sheets.

Whisked Biscuits: The name refers to the way in which the egg content is treated.

Egg whites are whisked until firm

Egg yolks/whole eggs are whisked together with the sugar until thickened and lightened.

These types of biscuits range from straight-forward whisked egg whites with added sugar in the form of light as air meringues to more substantial biscuits such as coconut macaroons.

Melted Biscuits: The recipes which include liquid sweeteners use honey, golden (corn) syrup or molasses. The biscuit is prepared after melting all sweeteners (including sugar) with fat and stirred until mixed well. The other ingredients are added to the melted ingredients and mixed in the saucepan. The mixture can be soft enough to easily drop from a spoon.

Varagu Biscuits

Ingredients		Quantity
Varagu flour	:	100 g
Wheat flour	:	100 g
Sugar (powder)	:	100 g
Cold butter	:	100 g
Baking powder	:	1 tsp
Vanilla essence	:	1/2 tsp
Milk	:	2 tsp

Method

- Roast varagu flour on a low flame until a nice aroma of roasted varagu is got. Allow it to cool.

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